

Pre-Channel Opportunity Signals

Plain-English guide for trapped-stock discovery (closings + returns). 30 signals from Pre-channel-opportunity-signals.csv. Abbreviations explained in parentheses on first use in each section.

Band It - Customer approved for Phase 1 build | May 2026

Glossary and customer rules

Key terms

- Trapped stock - Inventory stuck with an owner under pressure (closing, returns pile, overstock, cash stress) before a liquidator or marketplace gets it.
- Pre-channel - Same as trapped stock before Hilco, PFP, B-Stock, ReturnPro, or auction.
- TL - Truckload (roughly one semi-trailer of goods).
- DC - Distribution center (regional warehouse).
- GOB - Going out of business (store-closing sale).
- Ch7 / Ch11 - Chapter 7 or Chapter 11 U.S. bankruptcy.
- 3PL - Third-party logistics provider (stores/ships for another company).
- B-Stock - B2B (business-to-business) liquidation auction marketplace.
- ReturnPro / goTRG / Inmar - Large reverse-logistics processors.
- Hilco / PFP / Gordon Brothers / SB360 - Professional liquidation and GOB operators.
- PACER - Public Access to Court Electronic Records (federal courts).
- WARN - Worker Adjustment and Retraining Notification Act (U.S. mass layoff notice law).
- UCC - Uniform Commercial Code filing (lender claim on inventory).
- NAICS - North American Industry Classification System.

Customer hard rules (May 2026):

- S27: Bankruptcy in press or PR = too late - exclude.
- S26: Do not target companies IN the liquidation business.
- S28-S29: Tax liens and collection/vendor suits = early stress (Phase 1).

How to use

1. Monitor hunt signals (signal_role = hunt).
2. Apply exclude gates: S26 liquidation industry, S27 bankruptcy PR, S15 channel assigned.
3. Stack multiple hunt signals on one entity for priority.
4. Verify custody and call.

trap_types on each signal: closing | returns | overstock | financial.

EXCLUDE - DO NOT PURSUE

S15 - Channel assigned negative training

Role:	EXCLUDE - do not pursue
What it means:	Entity already on B-Stock ReturnPro DL Hilco PFP auction etc.
Why it matters:	Teaches agents what to drop - not a lead
Where to watch:	B-Stock seller list; press with liquidator name
Stop if you see:	Use to mark leads dead

S26 - Liquidation industry entity

Role:	EXCLUDE - do not pursue
What it means:	Target IS a liquidator broker auctioneer ReturnPro goTRG remarketer - not trapped stock source
Why it matters:	Customer rule: do not pursue companies in the liquidation business
Where to watch:	NAICS; company about page; B-Stock seller index
Stop if you see:	Always exclude as opportunity source

S27 - Bankruptcy public PR or press

Role:	EXCLUDE - do not pursue
What it means:	Bankruptcy filing announced via press release newspaper or trade press - customer says too late
Why it matters:	Window largely closed once public; use as negative training not hunt
Where to watch:	News; PR wires; Google News bankruptcy
Stop if you see:	Always deprioritize for outreach; log as missed window

CALIBRATE - LEARN FROM CUSTOMER WINS

S14 - Customer past win pattern

Role:	CALIBRATE - learn from customer wins
Trap types:	closing, returns, overstock
What it means:	Interview: replicate deals customer already got
Why it matters:	Defines positive training label - not a web find
Where to watch:	Customer meeting
Stop if you see:	Cannot verify externally

HUNT - TRAPPED STOCK CLUE

S01 - Distress before liquidator named

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, overstock
What it means:	Retailer/manufacturer in financial trouble but no Hilco/PFP/B-Stock/ReturnPro mentioned yet
Why it matters:	Short window to offer direct TL buy before professional disposition contract
Where to watch:	Local news; trade press; early whispers before PR
Stop if you see:	Store closing announced; warehouse mentioned; no named GOB firm in first articles

S02 - Operational shutdown before bankruptcy

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns
What it means:	Stores closed or ops halted weeks before Ch7/Ch11 filing appears in papers
Why it matters:	Inventory may sit in DC/showroom with no formal disposition yet
Where to watch:	Court filings; local TV/news; employee posts
Stop if you see:	S27 bankruptcy PR published OR Ch7 filed with trustee + auction schedule already published

S03 - Returns backlog without disposition hire

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	returns
What it means:	Company hiring returns/disposition roles at the retailer - not at a 3PL liquidator
Why it matters:	They may be building internal process because no vendor locked yet
Where to watch:	Indeed LinkedIn Glassdoor
Stop if you see:	Job is at ReturnPro Inmar Liquidity Services B-Stock OR employer is S26 liquidation industry

S04 - Excess inventory press no buyer named

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns, overstock
What it means:	Trade or earnings coverage cites excess stock warehouse costs; no liquidator cited
Why it matters:	Management may accept first serious truckload offer
Where to watch:	Furniture Today earnings; industry blogs; local biz journals
Stop if you see:	Article says retained Hilco or listed on B-Stock

S05 - 3PL storing unsold retail inventory

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	returns
What it means:	Third-party warehouse holds aged/returned product; owner not moving it
Why it matters:	3PL may pressure client or accept introducer to bulk buyer
Where to watch:	Overstock Trader seller docs; 3PL industry; freight brokers; LinkedIn
Stop if you see:	Inventory already listed on DL BULQ B-Stock OR 3PL is S26 liquidation industry

S06 - Regional ecommerce furniture stress

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	returns
What it means:	Strong dot-com home goods; weak reverse-logistics maturity; no public B2B program
Why it matters:	May negotiate direct before joining marketplace
Where to watch:	SimilarWeb lists; state biz search; site returns policy
Stop if you see:	Already on Wayfair-style marketplace as seller only OR S26 entity

S07 - Manufacturer overstock no retail partner

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	overstock
What it means:	Tariff cancel order factory overrun; factory or importer warehouse full
Why it matters:	Factory may sell TL once to avoid destruction
Where to watch:	Industry trade; import records; LinkedIn factory posts
Stop if you see:	Factory already uses Via Trading B-Stock regularly

S08 - Warehouse sublease or distress lease

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns, overstock
What it means:	Furniture DC/showroom space listed; tenant vacating; goods may remain
Why it matters:	Landlord or tenant may need bulk take-away
Where to watch:	CoStar LoopNet Crexi local brokers
Stop if you see:	Professional auctioneer named in listing

S09 - Ch11 early docket no press no liquidator

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, overstock
What it means:	Court docket shows new Ch11 with inventory on schedules BEFORE bankruptcy press/liquidator - silent early window
Why it matters:	363 sale period outreach to debtor counsel before public story
Where to watch:	PACER direct monitor (not BankruptcyObserver PR feed)
Stop if you see:	Monitor docket daily pre-press; contact debtor counsel with TL offer

S10 - Strategic store closure not bankruptcy

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns
What it means:	Retailer pruning stores; managing own clearance; DC inventory may lag stores
Why it matters:	Post-store-clearance DC phase often less public than GOB signs
Where to watch:	Retail Dive Furniture Today company PR
Stop if you see:	Full chain liquidation with Hilco already running

S11 - Local GOB not PFP run

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing
What it means:	Independent store everything must go; owner-run; not national GOB marketing firm
Why it matters:	Owner may sell bulk remainder after retail floor picked clean
Where to watch:	Facebook local news Craigslist
Stop if you see:	PFP Hilco banner on storefront or ad OR S26 liquidation company running sale

S12 - Dot com return rate spike public

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	returns
What it means:	Company complains about returns cost in press; no reverse-logistics vendor named
Why it matters:	Ops pain = openness to first buyer if approached respectfully
Where to watch:	Podcasts earnings calls trade press
Stop if you see:	Partnership announced with ReturnPro Narvar Optoro

S13 - UCC or lender inventory collateral

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	financial
What it means:	Lender files on inventory; borrower default; goods encumbered
Why it matters:	May need quick monetization before auction
Where to watch:	UCC filings state courts (manual)
Stop if you see:	Public auction notice with auctioneer

S16 - Floor plan inventory financing stress

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, financial
What it means:	Furniture dealer floor-plan curtailment or repossession (Triumph WF CIT etc.)
Why it matters:	Dealer may move stock before national GOB operator branded
Where to watch:	Trade press; lender suits; court
Stop if you see:	National liquidator named in same cycle

S17 - WARN act mass layoff

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns
What it means:	Worker Adjustment and Retraining Notification (WARN) at retailer or DC
Why it matters:	60-90 day window may align with DC wind-down
Where to watch:	dol.gov WARN; state WARN logs
Stop if you see:	S27 bankruptcy PR; use only stacked with S01 S02 S04

S18 - Restructuring advisor no liquidator

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, overstock

What it means:	AlixPartners FTI Riveron retained; no Hilco GOB in press yet
Why it matters:	Serious stress window before disposition contract
Where to watch:	Company PR; news
Stop if you see:	Follow-up names Hilco PFP or auctioneer

S19 - State ABC or receivership

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, overstock
What it means:	Assignment for benefit of creditors (ABC) or state receiver before public auction catalog
Why it matters:	Manufacturer/importer inventory in court-supervised sale early
Where to watch:	State court; receiver PR (PwC etc.)
Stop if you see:	Auction catalog live with auctioneer

S20 - Warehouse storage lien litigation

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	returns, financial
What it means:	3PL or warehouse sues retailer for unpaid storage - extends S05
Why it matters:	Goods may need bulk buyer to clear building
Where to watch:	civil court dockets
Stop if you see:	S15 channel assigned on inventory

S21 - Commercial eviction furniture tenant

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, overstock
What it means:	Landlord evicts furniture tenant; goods may remain
Why it matters:	Bulk takeaway to empty space
Where to watch:	county eviction indexes
Stop if you see:	Auctioneer named

S22 - Local warehouse sale ads

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns
What it means:	Craigslist/Facebook warehouse sale appointment only - not PFP/Hilco
Why it matters:	Scales S11; owner backroom clearance
Where to watch:	classifieds geo search
Stop if you see:	Obvious broker scam or S26 entity

S23 - Website ops diff

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing, returns
What it means:	Warehouse sale page sitewide clearance Maps closed before liquidator news
Why it matters:	Early digital signal before press
Where to watch:	watchlist domain fetch diff
Stop if you see:	Redirects to Hilco B-Stock partner

S24 - Public co inventory write down

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	overstock
What it means:	SEC 10-Q 8-K impairment excess obsolete home goods issuer
Why it matters:	Public pressure to move stock before formal program
Where to watch:	SEC EDGAR; earnings transcripts
Stop if you see:	Disposition vendor in same filing

S25 - Franchisee dealer group collapse

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	closing
What it means:	Local dealer LLC closes stores; HQ may still be solvent
Why it matters:	Inventory trapped at dealer not corporate channel
Where to watch:	Local news; SOS dealer entity
Stop if you see:	HQ national liquidation program live

S28 - Tax lien federal or state

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	financial
What it means:	IRS Notice of Federal Tax Lien or state tax lien on business
Why it matters:	Cash stress often months before bankruptcy PR
Where to watch:	county recorder; state lien portals; aggregators
Stop if you see:	Entity is S26 liquidation industry

S29 - Collection or vendor litigation

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	financial
What it means:	Debt collection suit judgment or vendor non-payment lawsuit against retailer/manufacturer
Why it matters:	Late pay proxy before public bankruptcy
Where to watch:	state civil court; judgment lien index
Stop if you see:	Entity is S26; or S27 bankruptcy PR already

S30 - Commercial credit deterioration

Role:	HUNT - trapped stock clue
Trap types:	financial
What it means:	D&B Paydex or Experian Business score sliding; deteriorating trade credit (paid data)
Why it matters:	Private company payment stress before public distress
Where to watch:	Experian D&B licensed API (Phase 2)
Stop if you see:	Requires licensed data - not web scrape